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DJIA 52475.10 ▲ 97.53 0.19% NASDAQ 26549.85 ▲ 0.3% STOXX 600 644.14 ▲ 0.1% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 13/32, yield 5.044% OIL $102.78 ▲ $2.88 GOLD $4,036.00 ▼ $22.80 EURO $1.1154 YEN 157.84

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The Fed held** interest rates steady, buying time to decide whether more rate rises are needed to keep energy costs and an AI building boom from seeping into broader inflation. **A1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose after the central bank's decision, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq both advancing 0.3% and the Dow gaining 0.2%. **B11**

◆ **Leaders at Weil, Gotshal** & Manges said that they plan to dissolve the law firm, capping a stunning fall for one of the most venerable names in the industry. **A1**

◆ **Google parent Alphabet** reported 25% revenue growth for the quarter, driven by gains in its cloud division, but revenue from search advertising decelerated. **B1**

◆ **Growth in Microsoft's** cloud business continued to accelerate in the company's most-recent quarter, contributing to a higher profit. **B1**

◆ **Nelson Peltz's Trian** hedge fund offered to buy Wendy's for around $1.4 billion, arguing that the fast-food chain would be better off as a private company. **B3**

◆ **Stellantis confirmed** its full-year guidance as turnaround efforts that include a comprehensive product offensive begin to support the automaker's earnings. **B2**

◆ **Ford reported** lower quarterly profit and revenue, pressured by losses in the company's EV unit and softer sales of other vehicles. **B2**

◆ **GSK shares fell** after the drugmaker reported lower-than-expected sales for its shingles vaccine Shingrix, the company's bestselling product. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **With three-quarters** of the vote counted, Benjamin Netanyahu's Likud Party appeared headed to win the largest number of seats in Israel's parliament, outpolling an opposition bloc that had made the election a referendum on the prime minister. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. administration's** decision to harbor defeated Brazilian presidential candidate Flávio Bolsonaro caps his family's long campaign to involve Trump and his circle in its legal and political battles at home. **A1**

◆ **With the U.S. midterms** looming, the Justice Department has attempted a frenzy of legal moves to advance Trump's demands to prosecute his political foes. **A4**

◆ **Trump called for** Democratic former Rep. Mary Peltola to be prosecuted and removed from the ballot in the Alaska Senate race, escalating his allegations of election interference. **A3**

◆ **The Trump administration** will require the companies that manage hundreds of billions of dollars of drug spending to disclose details on how they get paid. **A3**

◆ **Health Secretary** Robert F. Kennedy Jr. temporarily allowed six unapproved peptides to go to market despite scientists' warnings that there is too little evidence to prove they are safe or effective. **A3**

◆ **The U.S. expelled** a Cuban diplomat after the island's foreign minister and Mike Waltz, the U.S. ambassador to the United Nations, shouted at each other at the U.N. **A7**

◆ **Died: Alvin K. Hellerstein**, 92, presiding judge in weighty 21st-century cases. **A2**

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Fed Holds Steady, With Two Dissenters

Rate-setting panel nods subtly toward another increase, with eye on inflation

By Nick Timiraos

WASHINGTON—The Federal Reserve held interest rates steady Wednesday after last month's increase, buying time to decide whether more rate hikes are needed to keep energy costs and an artificial-intelligence building boom from seeping into broader inflation.

The decision, which maintained the Fed's benchmark rate in a range between 3.75% and 4%, was approved on a 10-2 vote. Fed governor Lisa Cook and Cleveland Fed President Beth Hammack dissented in favor of a quarter-point increase.

The committee's policy statement nodded subtly toward another increase.

"The accumulation of more information will help the committee determine the policy stance appropriate to ensure a timely return of inflation to the committee's 2% goal," it said.

In September, most officials projected they would raise rates at least once more this year, at either this week's meeting or the one that concludes Dec. 9.

At a news conference, Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh said market-based measures of expected inflation had moved lower even though energy prices have remained elevated since the September increase, which he took as a sign the Fed's approach was working. "I feel good about those signposts," he said.

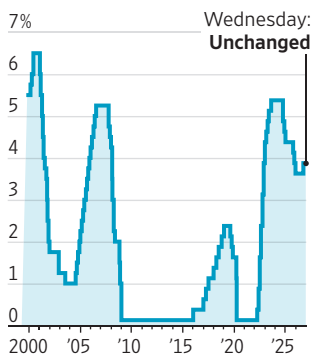
Warsh sidestepped questions about what would lead the Fed to raise rates again. He touted the recent strength of the economy, which he said had broadened beyond AI-related investment, and suggested officials would have a better understanding of economic and financial-market developments at their next meeting. "The period right in front of us is information rich," he said.

Warsh rejected the argument, popular among some

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◆ **Fed leaves U.S. investors sitting tight..... B11**

Federal-funds rate target



Note: Chart shows midpoint of target range since 2008.
Source: Federal Reserve

Spanish Train Collision Leaves Dozens Dead



MANU FERNANDEZ/AP

WRECKAGE: Emergency services work on the scene in Urda, Spain, after two high-speed trains collided Wednesday, killing at least 68 people and injuring around 70. It was the second deadly crash this year on the line between Madrid and Seville. **A8**

Storied Law Firm Weil Gotshal To Close

Leaders at Weil, Gotshal & Manges said at a firmwide meeting Wednesday afternoon that they plan to dissolve the law firm, capping a stunning fall for one of the most venerable names in the industry.

*By **Erin Mulvaney**, **Cara Lombardo** and **Alexander Gladstone***

The announcement followed a continued exodus of many of the firm's highest-earning partners and failed merger talks that left Weil in an untenable position. The dissolution of a well-regarded and profitable firm with some 1,200 lawyers worldwide is virtually unheard of. It reflects a wave of turmoil across the industry, as law firms battle for talent with $20 million-plus pay packages and face peril if they lose top moneymakers.

Barry Wolf, who has served as Weil's leader for 16 years, said on the firmwide call that management is recommending the dissolution, a person familiar with the matter said.

A partner vote is expected in the coming days.

"Following a careful review of strategic alternatives, the firm's management committee has recommended to the partnership that the firm pursue an orderly wind-down," the firm said.

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Bruised Netanyahu Stays Center Stage

By David S. Cloud And Anat Peled

TEL AVIV—In a four-decade career of feats of political survival, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's showing in Tuesday's election might have been his most improbable.

Netanyahu proved—under heavy opposition and despite a setback for his governing coalition—that he is still Israel's dominant politician.

With three-quarters of the vote counted, his Likud Party appeared headed to win the largest number of seats in Israel's parliament, the Knesset, outpolling an opposition bloc that had made the election a referendum on Netanyahu .

It was far from a complete victory. Netanyahu's coalition lost the majority it holds in the current parliament and lacks a clear path to a new one that would keep it in power. His bloc was projected to see its share of Knesset seats drop to 54 from 68. A majority of Israelis, including Israeli Arabs, voted against his party.

But under Israel's electoral system, that isn't enough to defeat him. Netanyahu's top showing and the likelihood that his coalition will outpoll his opponents mean he could get the nod from Israel's president to take the first attempt at forming a new government.

Even that mixed result was a major achievement for Netanyahu. His political future appeared doomed three years ago after the massacre of 1,200 people and mass hostage-taking by Hamas-led militants on Oct. 7, 2023, the worst defeat in Israel's history. He and his ministers were shouted down at funerals in the days following the attack. Some lawmakers in his own party told The Wall Street Journal at the time that his career was over.

Netanyahu has fought back from scandals, electoral de-

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◆ **Vance looks to restart Iran peace talks..... A8**

A Dream Cruise Ends Stranded in Cambodia

By Gabriele Steinhauser

They had been promised the voyage of a lifetime.

For as little as $100,000, passengers on the Odyssey, a 642-foot cruise ship, bought cabins and embarked on what they expected to be a years-long voyage around the world. Now, many find themselves stranded in a Cambodian port town after the ship's owner abruptly ended its journey, blaming soaring fuel prices.

The Odyssey, owned by Florida-based Villa Vie Residences, first set sail from Belfast, Northern Ireland, in October 2024 and stopped in more than 60 countries. Passengers—many U.S. retirees and remote workers—enjoyed a pool, a pickleball court, a theater, several bars and a gym with yoga and other classes. A doctor and two nurses were among the 150-strong crew.

But the Iran conflict has sent the price of shipping fuel soaring, leaving the vessel struggling to pay for, or at times even secure, sufficient fuel, the Odyssey's captain said in a German documentary broadcast in August.

Then, on Monday morning,

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Brew Crew Wins World Series



PHELAN M. EBENHACK/AP

AT LAST: The Brewers celebrate their first baseball championship since the franchise entered MLB in 1969 as the Seattle Pilots. Milwaukee defeated Tampa Bay 4-1. **A16.**

This Harvard Class Is Brutal. Why Is Everyone Signing Up?

* * *

Students embrace an inhumane reading list in search of an escape from the tyranny of AI

By Pamela Paul

Those who see the humanities, heavy coursework and value of a Harvard education as gravely imperiled can take heart in the phenomenon that is Humanities 10.

On a Tuesday morning in October, Samantha Matherne paced as she marked up on a white board explaining the philosophical underpinnings of Jane Austen's "Emma," with segues into Adam Smith and Immanuel Kant.

The philosophy professor posed big questions to the 90 students gathered in Boylston Hall: "Why did Austen create such an unlikable heroine?" she asked. "Why read novels at all?" And finally, as the 75-minute lecture ended, "What will become of Emma—and what will become of you?"

The students burst into ap-

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Bolsonaro's Escape: Decoys, a Key Ally

By Vera Bergengruen And Samantha Pearson

Less than 24 hours after losing Brazil's presidential election, Flávio Bolsonaro appeared to vanish into a convoy of four dark vans.

After pulling away from his home in Brasília Monday evening, the vehicles drove in different directions, leaving journalists and authorities scrambling to determine which one carried Bolsonaro. By Tuesday afternoon, the former presidential candidate's allies were telling reporters Bolsonaro was in Florida.

As Brazilian and international outlets reported that Bolsonaro had left the country, he was still in Brazil, while a private jet waited for him across the border in Argentina. At 12:21 a.m. Wednesday, the Gulfstream G400 took off from Puerto Iguazú and whisked him to Ecuador and then Miami, where

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◆ **Latin American right-wing surge threatened..... A6**

China's Car Industry Is Stalling at Home

Domestic sales plunge, but shakeout in state-supported sector hasn't begun

By Stephen Wilmot And Katrina Northrop

NANJING, China—Skyworth Auto's ambitions are visible everywhere in its electric-vehicle showroom here. A video spins the story of a founder who, like a Chinese version of Elon Musk, slept in the factory to get the company up and running. A map touts its presence in 45 countries. A new sport-utility vehicle is on display.

Back in 2021, Skyworth said its main EV plant could make 100,000 vehicles a year. Its actual sales in China this year through September: 660.

A brutal season has arrived in China's car market, among the most troubled in the world. Through September,

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